CSCI 7000-006
AI-driven Leadership

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Semester recap: What this seminar was really about

A quick refresher

STARTING POINT

Why now?

- • AI moved from tool to collaborator
- • Communicating with AI became a leadership skill
- • Organizations began redesigning work around AI, not just adding a tool

Big idea

The course was about learning to think, lead, and decide in an AI-augmented world.

OUR ARC THIS SEMESTER

1. **Understand AI** — prompting, communication, leadership context
2. **Reality check** — industry adoption, agents, executive trends
3. **Human impact** — Gen Z, workload, fatigue, jobs, trust
4. **Managerial response** — onboarding agents, building capability

What we learned about the market

AI adoption is accelerating — but implementation is still messy

INDUSTRY SIGNALS

From summit discussions and executive surveys:

- • Agentic AI moved to center stage
- • Leaders stayed bullish despite slow ROI
- • The biggest barriers were capability, workflow redesign, and governance

Bottom line:

The challenge is less "Can AI do it?" and more "Can organizations manage it well?"

From tools to agents

2023–24

Ask AI for answers

2025–26

Design AI-enabled workflows

Next

Manage humans + agents together

Leadership implication

Competitive advantage comes from experimentation, role clarity, and responsible oversight — not just buying a model.

What we learned about people and work

AI changes effort, identity, expectations, and attention

Gen Z paradox

Your generation uses AI fluently, but also worries about originality, skill loss, fairness, and what counts as “real” learning or work.

Class insight

Using AI well is also an ethical and developmental question.

Work intensification

AI often speeds up tasks — then raises expectations. Faster output can become more tasks, more review, and more pressure.

Class insight

Productivity gains do not automatically mean less work.

Brain fry

Not all AI use feels the same. Passive overreliance can create cognitive fatigue; intentional use can reduce friction without replacing thinking.

Class insight

The goal is augmentation, not mental outsourcing.

What strong AI leadership looks like

The course ended with capability-building, not hype

BEST USERS

What top AI users did differently

- • They treated AI as a reasoning partner
- • They gave clear goals, context, and constraints
- • They iterated instead of expecting one-shot perfection
- • They used AI to widen ambition, not only save time

Meaning for students

The most valuable habit is learning when to trust AI, challenge it, and build on it.

BEST ORGANIZATIONS

- Give agents a role, boundaries, and handoffs
- Train employees, not just deploy software
- Redesign workflows around human + AI collaboration
- **Keep governance, accountability, and judgment visible**

Final takeaway

AI advantage comes from better judgment, better systems, and better leadership.

Roundtable Leadership Development

Lesson Set 1

These lessons are designed to help students navigate transitions in their life.

Click any lesson to jump to its page

Windshields and Rearview Mirrors
Learning to let go of and learn from the past in order to move forward into the future.

A Compass or a GPS
Discovering your personal values and using them as a compass to give you direction in unfamiliar circumstances.

A Bridge Not a Wall
Walls are easy to build, bridges not so much. Just as walls divide and bridges connect, so too must we develop relational habits that form connections with others, instead of dividing us apart.

Baggage Fees
Most cars have trunks where we store luggage, but you can only fit so much. Some of us have far too much baggage. Bags in the trunk can weigh us down and get too big to carry. On flights, bags can cost us. We must discard them so they don't prevent us from moving forward.

Lesson Set 2

These lessons are designed to help students find and cultivate community.

Click any lesson to jump to its page

Hosts and Guests
Taking initiative to develop relationships.

The Talking Stick
Leaders are Listeners.

Chess and Checkers
Leveraging strengths to maximize impact.

The Calcutta Paradox
A leader's influence increases by showing humility.

Lesson Set 3

These lessons are designed to help students grow themselves and leaders who are ready for their next steps in life.

Click any lesson to jump to its page

The Iceberg
Developing character to build lasting influence.

The Starving Baker
Leaders feed themselves before feeding others.

Golden Statue
Look inside, find your strengths, use them to lead.

Thermostats and Thermometers
Leaders set the tone with values and attitude.